

NinjaTrader: a Chicago broker researching data centers and Equinix

Account entry plan for Spencer Refer | Prepared Thursday, October 1, 2026 | Sources: HubSpot, Lemlist, ZoomInfo, Apollo

91 Data Center intent score	84 Equinix intent score	2 NinjaTrader contacts in HubSpot	0 conversations so far
STAGE Prospect. No deal.	RUNNING NOW CTF ENT - Leaders (Dan Larson), added Sep 30	LAST TOUCH Sep 30: enrollment note; no email sent	NEXT STEP Mon Oct 5: email Dan Larson (Director of Security and Infrastructure)

Bottom line

NinjaTrader is a Chicago-based futures broker and trading platform, now owned by **Payward (Kraken)**. ZoomInfo shows **Data Center intent 91** and **Equinix intent 84**, which points straight at the Equinix Chicago campus where Crosstown is on-net. New leadership (SVP **Mark Omens, ex-CME**) and a push into **CME single-stock futures** add traffic to Chicago. The buyer is **Dan Larson, Director of Security and Infrastructure**. Lead with Equinix CH1/CH2/CH4 and CH3.

What NinjaTrader is, in one analogy

NinjaTrader is shopping for a new apartment in the Equinix building. Crosstown already has the keys to the hallways between those buildings.

Signals worth citing

Signal	Source	So what for the opener
Data Center intent 91; Equinix intent 84	ZoomInfo intent	Researching Equinix now. We're on-net there.
Mark Omens named SVP (ex-CME)	ZoomInfo news	CME relationships deepen.
CME single-stock futures; parent Payward (Kraken)	ZoomInfo news	More products, more Chicago traffic.
Dan Larson, Director of Security and Infrastructure	HubSpot	Buyer.

Work already in motion

One enrollment so far.

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
Sep 30	CTF ENT - Leaders	Dan Larson enrolled	No messages yet

Who to reach, in order

Contact	Title (source)	Where	Why they matter	Status / email
Dan Larson	Director of Security and Infrastructure (HubSpot)	Chicago (HQ)	Buyer.	Leaders; not yet emailed
Gil Burns	IT Operations Manager (HubSpot)	n/a	Operations.	Not contacted

Not worth chasing for this goal

Mark Omens is business-side; mention him, don't pitch him.

How the access path should run



Messages, by contact

1. Dan Larson Director of Security and Infrastructure

Why them: Matches Equinix intent.

Channel: Email Mon Oct 5 | Subject: NinjaTrader and the Equinix Chicago campus

Dan, if NinjaTrader is looking at Equinix Chicago, Crosstown is on-net at CH1, CH2 and CH4 at 350 E Cermak and CH3 in Elk Grove, with underground fiber mapped to the conduit. That makes diverse paths between those sites simple to prove. Worth 20 minutes to look at the map?

2. Gil Burns IT Operations Manager

Why them: Second touch.

Channel: Email Thu Oct 8 | Subject: Chicago conduit map (KMZ)

Gil, I can send our Chicago route map in KMZ showing our Equinix paths. Useful for your planning?

The plan

When	Move	Notes
Mon Oct 5	Email Dan Larson; pause his generic Leaders step.	-
Thu Oct 8	Email Gil Burns.	-
Mon Oct 12	LinkedIn connect to Larson.	-
Week of Oct 19	Goal: Equinix path review.	-
Nov	Proposal if a move is under way.	-

What progress looks like (for management)

By	Milestone	How we will know
Oct 16	Reply from Larson or Burns	Logged
Oct 30	Path review held	Meeting logged
Nov 30	Quote requested	Deal created

Guardrails

- Don't claim knowledge of their Equinix plans; intent data is a hint.
- Credits used: Apollo person enrichment; ZoomInfo company and signals for 1 company.

Sources

HubSpot contacts and notes (Sep 30); Lemlist CTF ENT Leaders; ZoomInfo intent and news; Apollo people data.